SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "VACQUEYRAS"

approved by decree no. 2011-1548 of 14 November 2011, JORF of 17 November 2011

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Vacqueyras", initially recognised by the decree of 9 August 1990.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No specific provision.

III. – Colours and type of product

The controlled designation of origin "Vacqueyras" is reserved for still white, red and rosé wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Vaucluse department: Sarrians, Vacqueyras.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 21 and 22 February 1990.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

Ardèche department: Saint-Jean-de-Muzols, Tournon-sur-Rhône

Drôme department: Les Granges-Gontardes, Mercurol, Pont-de-l'Isère, La Roche-de-Glun, Tain-l'Hermitage

Rhône department: Ampuis, Condrieu, Tupin-et-Semons

Vaucluse department: Althen-des-Paluds, Aubignan, Le Barroux, Beaumes-de-Venise, Beaumont-du-Ventoux, Bédarrides, Bedoin, Blauvac, Brantes, Buisson, Cairanne, Camaret-sur- Aigues, Caromb, Carpentras, Châteauneuf-du-Pape, Courthézon, Crestet, Crillon-le-Brave, Entraigues-sur-la-Sorgue, Entrechaux, Faucon, Flassan, Gigondas, Jonquerettes, Jonquières, Lafare, Loriol-du-Comtat, Malaucène, Mazan, Malemort-du-Comtat, Méthamis, Modène, Monteux, Mormoiron, Orange, Puyméras, Rasteau, Roaix, La Roque-Alric, Sablet, Saint-Hyppolyte-le- Graveyron, Saint-Léger-du-Ventoux, Saint-Marcellin-lès-Vaison, Saint-Pierre-de-Vassols, Saint- Romain-en-Viennois, Saint-Roman-de-Malegarde, Saint-Saturnin-lès-Avignon, Savoillan, Séguret, Procédure nationale d'opposition suite à l'avis du Comité national des appellations d'origine relatives aux vins et aux boissons alcoolisées, et des eaux-de-vie du 12 Février 2015 Sérignan-du-Comtat, Sorgues, Suzette, Travaillan, Uchaux, Vaison-la-Romaine, Vedène, Villedieu, Villes-sur-Auzon, Violès

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The white wines come from the following varieties: bourboulenc B, clairette B, grenache blanc B, marsanne B, roussanne B, viognier B;

b) – The red wines come from the following varieties: - main variety: grenache N; - complementary varieties: mourvèdre N, syrah N; - accessory varieties: bourboulenc B, brun argenté N (locally called camarèse or vaccarèse), carignan N, cinsaut N, clairette B, clairette rose Rs, counoise N, grenache blanc B, grenache gris G, marsanne B, muscardin N, piquepoul noir N, roussanne B, terret noir N, viognier B.

c) – The rosé wines come from the following varieties: - main varieties: cinsaut N, grenache N, mourvèdre N, syrah N; - accessory varieties: bourboulenc B, brun argenté N (locally called camarèse or vaccarèse), carignan N, clairette B, clairette rose Rs, counoise N, grenache blanc B, grenache gris G, marsanne B, muscardin N, piquepoul noir N, roussanne B, terret noir N, viognier B.

d) – Plantings may not be carried out with the following plant material: - for the grenache N variety: clones 70, 134, 137, 224, 287, 432, 514, 517, 814; - for the syrah N variety: clones 73, 99, 301, 381, 382, 383.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

The conformity of the grape varieties is assessed, for the colour concerned, over the totality of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin.

a) – White wines: - Each of the varieties may not represent more than 80 % of the grape varieties.

b) – Red wines: - The proportion of the whole of the main variety and complementary varieties is greater than or equal to 90 % of the grape varieties; - The proportion of the grenache N variety is greater than or equal to 50 % of the grape varieties; - The proportion of the whole of the mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties is greater than or equal to 20 % of the grape varieties; - These proportion rules do not apply to grape-producing operators that do not vinify their production and exploit a total area (all colours combined) within the delimited parcel area of less than 1.5 hectare under the controlled designation of origin "Vacqueyras"; - The proportion of the whole of the accessory varieties is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties; - The proportion of the whole of the white varieties is less than or equal to 5 % of the grape varieties.

c) – Rosé wines: - Each of the main varieties may not represent more than 80 % of the grape varieties; - The proportion of the whole of the accessory varieties is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.

- The spacing between rows may not be greater than 2.50 metres; - Each plant has a maximum area of 2.50 square metres. This area is obtained by multiplying the inter-row and inter-plant distances within the same row; - The spacing between plants within the same row is between 0.85 metre and 1.20 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.

GENERAL PROVISIONS
- The vines are short-pruned (trained in goblet or in Royat cordon), with a maximum of 6 spurs. Each spur bears a maximum of 2 free eyes (buds). - The establishment or rejuvenation period of the Royat cordon is limited to 2 years. During this period, Guyot pruning, with a long cane with a maximum of 8 free eyes and a spur with a maximum of 2 free eyes, is authorised.
PARTICULAR PROVISION
The viognier B variety may be pruned: - either in single Guyot with a maximum of 8 free eyes on the long cane and 1 or 2 spurs with a maximum of 2 free eyes; - or in double Guyot with a maximum of 6 free eyes on each long cane and 1 or 2 spurs with a maximum of 2 free eyes.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.

- For vines trained in cordon, the maximum height of the cordon is 0.65 metre, this height being measured from the ground to the lower part of the framework arms; - For vines trained according to the "raised single-plane trellising" method, the height of the trellised foliage must be at least equal to 0.5 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least

0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire. - For all the other training methods, the length of the shoots, after topping, may not be less than 0.70 metre. - The syrah N variety is compulsorily trellised, either on stakes or in "raised single-plane trellising" with, in the latter case, at least one carrier wire and one level of lifting wires.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
- The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 6,500 kilograms per hectare; - Where irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 5,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir: - Plastic mulching is prohibited; - The control of the spontaneous vegetation is carried out, from 1 September to 1 February, either by mechanical means or by equipment ensuring a precise localisation of the treatment products. - On at least 60 % of the area comprised between two rows, either a soil tillage is carried out or a sown or spontaneous plant cover is present. In the latter case, the control of the spontaneous vegetation is carried out either by mechanical means or by equipment allowing a precise localisation of the treatment products.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions. The harvest is sound and previously sorted if the sanitary condition necessitates it, whatever the harvesting method.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes. Grapes presenting a sugar content lower than the following may not be considered as being at proper ripeness: - 216 grams per litre for the grenache N variety; - 207 grams per litre of must for the other black varieties; - 196 grams per litre of must for the white varieties.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of: - 12.50 % for the red wines; - 12 % for the rosé and white wines.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 36 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 40 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Loss of the benefit of the controlled designation of origin

The wines are obtained within the limit of a yield of 42 hectolitres per hectare. This yield corresponds to the total production of the claimed parcels. Any exceeding of this yield causes the whole of the harvest to lose the benefit of the controlled designation of origin.

4° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of the varieties. The red wines come from the blending of grapes or wines arising mainly from the main variety and from at least one of the 2 complementary varieties.

b) – Malolactic fermentation. The red wines present, at the packaging stage, a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards.

COLOUR OF THE WINES, AND COMPLEMENTARY TERM	**CONTENT OF FERMENTABLE SUGARS AND STAGE AT WHICH THE VALUE APPLIES (grams per litre) (glucose + fructose)**	**VOLATILE ACIDITY CONTENT AND STAGE AT WHICH THE VALUE APPLIES (milliequivalents per litre)**	**MODIFIED COLOUR INTENSITY (OD 420 nm + OD 520 nm + OD 620 nm)**	**TOTAL POLYPHENOL INDEX (OD 280 nm)**
White, red or rosé wines (with natural alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 14 %)	Less than or equal to 3 (at packaging)			
White, red or rosé wines (with natural alcoholic strength by volume greater than 14 %)	Less than or equal to 4 (at packaging)			
White or rosé wines		Less than or equal to 14.28 (bulk transaction and packaging)		
Red wines		Less than or equal to 17.35 (bulk transaction and packaging)	Greater than or equal to 5 (at packaging)	Greater than or equal to 45 (at packaging)

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments. - The use of pieces of wood is prohibited; - For the elaboration of the rosé wines, the use of charcoals for oenological use, alone or in a mixture in

preparations, is prohibited; - The wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 14 %.

e) – Vat capacity. Every operator has an overall vat capacity greater than or equal to 1.5 times the product of the yield referred to at 1° of point VIII by the area in production vinified at the cellar.

f) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

g) – Control of the fermentation temperatures. The vinification units are equipped with a system for controlling the fermentation temperatures, with the exception of tubular trickle systems.

2° – Provisions by type of product

a) – The white and rosé wines undergo ageing at least until 1 January of the year following that of the harvest;

b) – The red wines undergo ageing at least until 15 January of the year following that of the harvest.

3° – Wine analysis obligations

For all the homogeneous lots of wines, the operator keeps available for the approved control body an analysis covering the following parameters:

During the conservation of the non-packaged wines and at least every six months from the date of the claim declaration	
- Volatile acidity; - Free sulphur dioxide.	
At the packaging stage	
White, red or rosé wines	- Total acidity; - Volatile acidity; - Actual alcoholic strength by volume; - Fermentable sugars; - Total sulphur dioxide; - pH.
Red wines	- Total polyphenol index; - Modified colour intensity.

4° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis reports are kept for a period of at least 6 months from the date of packaging.

5° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a specific place for the storage of the packaged products.

6° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer. - At the end of the ageing period, the white and rosé wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 15 January of the year following that of the harvest; - At the end of the ageing period, the red wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 31 January of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers. The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on 31 December of the year of harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

Within the southern vineyards of the Rhône Valley and recognised as a “cru des Côtes du Rhône”, the territory of the controlled designation of origin “Vacqueyras” is one of the territories that encircle the remarkable limestone massif of the Dentelles de Montmirail. This admirable mountain, “mons mirabilis”, bears witness to the first Alpine advance towards the Rhône Valley, which it comes partially to cut from east to west. An imposing relief, culminating at 630 metres of altitude at the Rocher du Turc, a spectacular

relief through the play of erosion, it constitutes the most complex geological structure on the left bank of the Rhône, with substrates arising from the Triassic, Jurassic and Cretaceous formations, surrounded by a halo of Oligocene and Miocene formations. Between the geographical area of the controlled designation of origin "Gigondas" to the north and that of the controlled designation of origin "Beaumes de Venise" to the south-east, situated on the left bank of the Ouvèze, the geographical area is inscribed within the communes of Vacqueyras and Sarrians, in the Vaucluse department.

Between the imposing limestone massif and the terraces of the Ouvèze, the bedrocks constituting the base of this territory are of quite diverse origins, from the Secondary era (limestone and gravels), to the Tertiary (sands and sandy soils) and to the Quaternary for the sandstones and clays. The lacustrine and marine alluviations played a great role in the stratification of these materials composing a soil conducive to the cultivation of the vine. The alluvial terrace of the "Garrigues" is essentially made up of the marine deposits and the lacustrine deposits carried by the Ouvèze, with poor soils, essentially clayey-limestone, with a red clayey matrix and rolled pebbles. The glacial terraces of the Riss, a Quaternary formation, are more recent than the "Garrigues". The weathered ancient alluvium has given way to materials of a grey tint put in place by runoff over the last millennia. These materials (rich in clay) have moved slowly and have covered a part of the "Garrigues", giving this formation the shape of a cone. Vacqueyras, like the small valleys situated between the village and the eastern edge of the "Garrigues", is established on the "safres" of the Comtat Venaissin, safres of the Tertiary era. These are materials of limestone origin corresponding to sandstones and fine limestones alternating with marls.

"Vacqueyras" fully justifies its ancient denomination: "Vallis Quadreria", "Valley of Stones", within which the vineyard was mainly established on wide terraces of the Ouvèze, at an altitude of between 60 metres and 160 metres. The climate is Mediterranean, hot and dry, with a particularly important sunshine. It is, however, contrasted, with a low annual rainfall of 600 millimetres to 800 millimetres but very irregular and sometimes with strong rainy episodes at the equinoxes. The geographical area is also subject, for a large part of the year (more than 100 days per year), to the influence of the Mistral, a north wind, violent and cold. Here we are at the eastern limit of the hottest climatic sector of the geographical area of the controlled designation of origin "Côtes du Rhône", tempered by the influence of the pre-Alpine massif of the Dentelles de Montmirail.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The presence of the vine in the Roman period is attested within the geographical area by the recent unearthing of a Gallo-Roman villa. The study of this villa concluded that there existed on this site, at first, a plantation of olive trees, replaced, doubtless after a period of frost, by a plantation of vines. The cadastre of 1521 records, on the territory of the commune of Vacqueyras, 480 parcels of which 85 are planted with vine and distributed among some fifty owners. The cadastre of 1596 evaluates the areas planted with vine at 60 hectares and the owners at 66. The progression continues over the years. In 1630, 75 hectares of vine are recorded and, in 1671, 78 hectares.

In 1724, a deliberation, concerning measures for the protection of the vines, results in the appointment of a keeper of the vineyard. It is a question of "sanctioning the offences caused to the vineyard". In the aftermath of the Revolution, in 1828, the whole of the cultivated lands occupies 720 hectares, of which 84 hectares of vines. In the 19th century, no notable change is recorded, until the phylloxera crisis which, from 1860 to the end of the century, will severely affect all the wine regions. The vineyard of "Vacqueyras" is not spared, but the winegrowing community sets about reconstituting it fairly quickly. Despite the vicissitudes, the viticultural vocation of "Vacqueyras" never ceases to assert itself and, in 1915, 368 hectares of vine are counted, that is to say about 4 times more than a century earlier. In 1950, the area under vine is 580 hectares.

Initially inscribed within the geographical area of the controlled designation of origin "Côtes du Rhône" (decree of 19 November 1937), the production of this territory is quickly recognised for its quality and for the identity of its wines. It is therefore naturally integrated, as early as 1955, within the controlled designation of origin "Côtes du Rhône Villages" and, in 1967, the name of the commune may be added to the name of this same controlled designation of origin. Responding to the wish of the producers to see its know-how, and the identity and the notoriety of the wines, recognised, the controlled designation of origin "Vacqueyras" is recognised, by decree of 15 August 1990, thus joining the family of the "Crus des Côtes

du Rhône". In 2009, the vineyard covers an area of 1,462 hectares for an average production of 44,000 hectolitres. The only controlled designation of origin of the left bank of the Rhône in this case, the wines are divided into the three colours (red wines 95 %, rosé wines 2 %, white wines 3 %) and are elaborated by 175 producers, of whom 130 in cooperative cellars and 45 in private cellars.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The white wines, although representing only a small proportion of the production, testify to a strong identity with aromas that are mainly floral, tempered by fruity notes of citrus. On the palate, their structure and their nervousness give them an amplitude and a long aromatic persistence. The red and rosé wines come mainly from the grenache N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties.

The rosé wines, a production just as confidential as that of the white wines, fairly coloured, are rich and powerful, generally with a fruity dominance. They are also distinguished by a long aromatic persistence. The red wines, a very largely predominant production, are marked by the different types of soils encountered. They are nevertheless distinguished by a strong identity, frequently brought out by a fairly long ageing period, even if this is not imposed. The aromas are complex, dominated by red or black fruits, often with accents of over-ripeness, of candied or jammy fruits. The evolution gives them more spicy, more animal notes (leather, game, etc.). The palate is generous, ample, full-bodied, imposing through its tannic structure without the latter being aggressive. They are powerful, round and elegant wines for keeping.

3° – Causal interactions

Combining, on the one hand, natural factors conducive to an original expression of the potential of the harvest, with soils of strong permeability (sands, stony sandstones, rolled pebbles), frequently associated with a clayey matrix apt to offer an interesting water reserve during the dry periods; on the other hand, a Mediterranean climate tempered by the proximity of the Dentelles de Montmirail, apt to allow good conditions of ripeness of the berries, without excess of temperatures and leaving room for the beneficial effects of the Mistral both on concentration and on protection against cryptogamic diseases; and finally, human factors which, over the generations, are revealed through the know-how of the operators in the establishment of the varieties and in the blends of harvests — the wines claimed under the controlled designation of origin "Vacqueyras" testify to the originality of this territory.

These interactions are read particularly well in the red wines, complex blends between power and tannic structure, which are found in the harvests from the rolled pebbles; finesse and fruity aromas of the harvests from the more sandy soils; harmony and balance in the harvests from the stony sandstones. Strong with this potential, the know-how implemented makes it possible, while respecting the originalities of the raw material, to maintain the identity of the red wines. In a fairly exceptional way in this wine zone, the particular identity of the wines produced has also been recognised for the white wines and the rosé wines, which benefit, here, from the same qualitative incidences linked both to the natural factors and to the production usages.

Notoriety, know-how, usages and quality of the wines can be read through a journey around the vineyard of "Vacqueyras", through an important and preserved rural heritage, linked to the agricultural activity with many "cabanons" (small huts), and make the wines of "Vacqueyras", since 1998, the official wines of the Avignon Festival.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Grape varieties

The provisions relating to the prohibition of certain clones do not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009.

2° – Training methods

a) – Planting density. - The provisions relating to the maximum area per plant and to the maximum distance between rows do not apply to the plantings carried out before 9 August 1990; - The provision relating to the spacing between plants within the same row does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009; - The parcels planted with vine before 9 August 1990 and not meeting the provisions

relating to planting density continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up, subject to compliance with the provisions relating to the foliage height fixed in the present specification.

b) – Pruning rules. For the vines planted before 1 September 1980, the maximum number of free eyes per plant is fixed at 16.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height. - The provision relating to the trellising obligation for the syrah N variety does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009; - The provision relating to the height of the cordon does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009.

3° – Other cultivation practices

The provision relating to the prohibition of plastic mulching does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009.

4° – Oenological practices

The provision relating to the fermentation-temperature control systems applies from the 2014 harvest.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Vacqueyras" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit "Cru des Côtes du Rhône" or "Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône". The conditions of use of the larger geographical unit "Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône" are specified by the agreement signed between the various defence and management bodies concerned, relating to the conditions of use of this larger geographical unit.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least 10 working days before the first bulk transaction or the first packaging, and at the latest on 15 December of the year of harvest. It indicates: - the designation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts, as well as, where applicable, the list of the parcels having more than 20 % of dead or missing plants, with indication of the percentage for each of them.

2. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, before 1 May preceding the harvest, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin. This declaration specifies for each parcel whether they are intended for the production of a more general controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body transmits this declaration to the approved control body as soon as possible.

3. Declaration of bulk transaction or of bulk sale to the consumer and declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

A declaration of bulk transaction, or a declaration of bulk sale to the consumer, is sent to the approved control body at the latest 10 working days before the date of exit from the cellars. This declaration

specifies, where applicable, whether the non-packaged wine is intended to be dispatched outside the national territory.

4. Prior declaration of packaging

Every operator wishing to package a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes, to the approved control body, a prior packaging declaration for the lot concerned within a period of 10 working days before the operation. Operators carrying out more than 10 packaging operations per year are exempted from this declaration obligation, but send, each quarter, a summary declaration.

5. Fallback (repli) declaration (marketing under a more general appellation)

Every operator marketing a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin under a more general appellation makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body simultaneously with the declaration of bulk transaction or of bulk sale to the consumer, where applicable with the declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine, or with the prior packaging declaration.

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of one month after this downgrading.

7. Declaration of end of works

Following a planting or a top-grafting, a copy of the declaration of end of works is sent to the defence and management body simultaneously with its lodging with the viticulture service of the DGDDI. It is accompanied by a copy of the transport document for the plants or grafts.

II. – Keeping of registers

No specific provision.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary check of the classification of the parcels of the holding within the delimited area by cross-referencing the CVI record and the cadastral plans bearing the outline of the parcel delimitation
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of transitional measures)	Documentary check
A3 – New planting	Before entry into production, check in the field of the planting density, of the establishment height of the cordon, of the variety and of the clone (according to the plant transport document) and of the absence of plastic mulching
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Average maximum load per parcel	Counting of the average number of bunches and estimation of the load by multiplying this number by the average weight of a bunch (adapted to the variety)
Upkeep of the parcel and other cultivation practices	Check of the overall upkeep of the parcel (weed management, sanitary condition, trellising, missing vines)
Irrigation	Check of the declaration obligations and check of the average maximum load per parcel

B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Sorting of the harvest	Check in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Analytical monitoring of the product during conservation	Check of the analytical monitoring of the wine (check of free SO2 and volatile acidity) every six months from the date of the claim declaration
Packaging	Documentary check (complete analysis of the blended wines at the packaging stage)
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	Documentary check (register keeping) and check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check [check of declarations, increase of the yield for certain operators (monitoring of the authorisations granted by the INAO services, after enquiry by the said services upon individual request of the operator)]
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check (monitoring of destruction certificates)
Claim declaration	Documentary check and on-site check (compliance with the arrangements and deadlines, consistency with the harvest declaration, etc.). Control of the placing into circulation of the products
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
At the stage of the placing into circulation of the non-packaged products and at the packaging stage	Complete analytical examination of the wine
At the stage of the placing into circulation of the non-packaged products and/or at the packaging stage	Organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
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The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, under the authority of the INAO, on the basis of an approved inspection plan.

The inspection plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.